After the raid, Ragothaman asked Haribabu's mother if there was something she was hiding; if she was, its consequences could land them in jail. The mother started howling and then, recovering herself, said, 'Two photographers, Shubha Sundaram and Ravi Shankar, came to our house early on the morning of 22 May. They were looking for Haribabu's camera. I said Haribabu had not come home since the previous day. But they never told me about my son's death.' Unable to carry on, she started rolling around on the floor and crying loudly.

Ragothaman knew this was the moment he had to press the parents for the truth. Eventually, Haribabu's mother led the SIT to a friend of Haribabu's—Kannan—who confirmed her story to Ragothaman. The SIT started tapping the phones of photojournalist Ravi Shankar and Shubha Sundaram and put both under surveillance.

Verma passed on a box to Ragothaman after he returned to office. 'Ragothaman, it has come from the Q Branch, the special wing of the CID that looked into the LTTE's activities in Tamil Nadu. They received it from an anonymous source. Apparently, Haribabu had kept it hidden at a relative's place. The relative probably thought the contents would help the investigation after reading about Haribabu in the newspapers.'

'Have you gone through it, sir?' Ragothaman asked.

'Nope. You can go ahead.'

Ragothaman took it to his desk for examination. There was a small note addressed to Haribabu from Bhagyanathan, asking him to pay Muthuraja's electricity bill and hand over the receipt to Murugan. It gave the SIT three new names—Bhagyanathan, Muthuraja and Murugan. However, Ragothaman's assistant, who Ragothaman passed on the contents to for making a list, came across a picture of LTTE supremo Prabhakaran, copies of LTTE calendars, a list of a large number of medicines to treat wounds, sketches of the Vellore fort, where a large number of LTTE cadres were detained, and some personal letters from Haribabu's girlfriend Sundari. The love letters immediately caught the assistant's attention, one of which indicated that Haribabu was going on a 'dangerous mission' and Sundari was trying to discourage him.[1]